TRIPLE TRIAD

FINAL FANTASY VIII

The legendary card game from Final Fantasy VIII, reimagined as a full single-player campaign. 110 unique cards with AI-generated artwork. 6 regions. 30+ locations. 100+ NPCs. All 8 special rules and 4 trade rules. Story-driven progression across 13 chapters.

Play in your browser or install on Android.

Version 1.0.0 — Game Guide & Installation

What's Inside

Triple Triad v1.0 is the most faithful fan recreation of the FFVIII card game ever built. Whether you're a veteran card player or discovering Triple Triad for the first time, this is your definitive experience.

🌍

Full Campaign

Travel across 6 regions and 30+ locations following the FF8 storyline. Challenge 100+ NPCs, each with unique dialogue and level-appropriate decks.

🃏

110 Unique Cards

Every card features custom AI-generated artwork. Collect them all through duels, shops, tournaments, and quest rewards.

⚔️

All 8 Special Rules

Open, Same, Same Wall, Plus, Combo, Elemental, Random, and Sudden Death — all implemented faithfully.

📜

Quest System

13 main story quests and 20+ side quests. Track your progress in the Quest Log with story recaps and objectives.

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Queen of Cards

Late-game NPC who can spread or abolish rules across any region — for a price. Master the rule system.

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Android App

Full-featured Android build with edge-to-edge display, system back button navigation, and offline play.

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2-Player Online

Challenge a friend with room codes. Pick your deck, apply special rules, and duel in real time via WebSocket.

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Smart AI

Alpha-beta pruning AI with difficulty levels. NPCs play intelligently — harder opponents in later regions.

How to Play

The Basics

Triple Triad is played on a **3×3 grid**. Each player has **5 cards**. Players take turns placing one card on an empty cell. The goal: own the **majority of cards** (6 or more out of 10) when the board is full.

Card Ranks

Every card has 4 rank numbers — one per side: **Top, Right, Bottom, Left**. Ranks range from 1 to 10 (10 is shown as **A**). When you place a card adjacent to an opponent's card, compare the touching sides. If your rank is higher, you **capture** their card (it flips to your colour).

Special Rules

Different regions play with different rules. These change how captures work:

Rule	Effect
Open	You can see the opponent's hand before playing.
Same	If your card's touching ranks equal the adjacent cards' ranks on 2+ sides, capture those cards. Triggers Combo.
Same Wall	Board edges count as rank A (10) for Same checks.
Plus	If the sums (your rank + their rank) are equal on 2+ sides, capture those cards. Triggers Combo.
Combo	Cards captured by Same/Plus cascade — any adjacent weaker card is also captured.
Elemental	Board cells have elements. Matching element: +1 to all ranks. Mismatched: −1.
Random	Your 5 cards are randomly chosen from your deck.
Sudden Death	On a draw, the game replays with the board as-is until someone wins.

Trade Rules

What happens to cards after a match:

Rule	Stakes
One	Winner takes 1 card from the loser.
Diff	Winner takes 1 card per point of score difference.
Direct	Each player keeps the cards in their colour at game end.

All	Winner takes ALL of the loser's played cards.

> **Tip:** In-game tutorial popups explain each rule the first time you encounter it. You can revisit all tutorials from the **Guide** tab at any time.

The World of Triple Triad

Your journey follows the FF8 storyline across 6 regions, each with unique rules and increasing difficulty.

Region	Special Rules	Trade Rule	Chapter
Balamb	Open	One	1–3
Galbadia	Same	One	2–5
FH	Elemental, Sudden Death	Diff	4–7
Trabia	Random, Plus	Diff	6–9
Centra	Same, Plus, Combo	Direct	8–11
Esthar	Elemental, Same Wall, Random	All	9–13

Rule Spreading

After Chapter 5, dueling in a new region can carry rules from your last-played region. Rules can spread to or be abolished from regions over time. The **Queen of Cards** in Esthar City lets you deliberately manipulate rules across any region for a gil fee.

Progression

- **Win duels** to earn gil and capture opponent cards
- **Buy cards** from shops in each town
- **Enter tournaments** for rare card prizes
- **Complete quests** to unlock new regions and earn rewards
- **Build your deck** — save multiple deck loadouts for different strategies

Settings

Accessible from the title screen. Customise your experience:

- **Text Scale** (70%–150%) — adjust all game text with a live preview
- **Card Overlay** (0–150%) — control the size of rank numbers on cards, or turn them off entirely for a clean art-only look

Running on Web (Docker)

The web version runs entirely via Docker — no Node.js, no local dependencies needed.

Prerequisites

- **Docker Desktop** (Windows/Mac) or Docker Engine (Linux)
- **Git** to clone the repository

Quick Start

1. **Clone the repository**

```
git clone https://github.com/Alex-ReachIndustries/TripleTriad.git
cd TripleTriad
```

2. **Start with Docker Compose**

```
docker compose up -d --build
```

This builds and starts both the frontend dev server and the WebSocket backend for 2P duels.

3. **Open in your browser**

```
http://localhost:5173
```

The game loads immediately. Your save data is stored in your browser's localStorage.

4. **To stop**

```
docker compose down
```

> **Note:** The 2P Duel mode requires the backend WebSocket server (included in docker-compose). Single-player World Mode works entirely in the browser with no backend needed.

Production Build

To create an optimised static build:

```
docker run --rm -v "$(pwd)/frontend:/app" -w /app node:22-slim sh -c "npm ci && npm run bu
ild"
```

The output in `frontend/dist/` can be served by any static file server (Nginx, Caddy, GitHub Pages, etc.).

Installing on Android

The Android APK is available on the **GitHub Releases** page. Since it's not from the Play Store, you'll need to allow installation from unknown sources.

Download

1. **Get the APK**
   Go to the GitHub Releases page and download **TripleTriad.apk** from the latest release (v1.0.0).

   ```
   https://github.com/Alex-ReachIndustries/TripleTriad/releases
   ```

2. **Transfer to your device**
   If you downloaded on a PC, transfer the APK to your phone via USB cable, cloud storage, or email it to yourself.

Enable Unknown Sources

> **Important:** Android blocks apps from outside the Play Store by default. You need to temporarily allow installation from the source you're using (browser, file manager, etc.).

Android 8.0+ (Oreo and newer)

1. **Open the APK file** on your phone (tap the download notification or find it in your file manager).
2. **Android will prompt:** "For your security, your phone is not allowed to install unknown apps from this source."
3. Tap **Settings** on the prompt. This opens the per-app install permission screen.
4. Toggle **"Allow from this source"** (or "Install unknown apps") to ON.
5. Go back and tap **Install**.
6. *Optional but recommended:* After installing, go back to **Settings > Apps > Special access > Install unknown apps** and toggle the permission back OFF for security.

Android 7.0 and older

1. Go to **Settings > Security**.
2. Enable **"Unknown sources"** (this is a global toggle on older Android).
3. Open the APK and tap **Install**.
4. Disable "Unknown sources" again after installation.

After Installation

- Find **Triple Triad** in your app drawer and tap to launch.
- The game runs entirely offline — no internet connection needed for single-player.
- Use the Android **back button** to navigate (tabs → world → title screen).
- Your save data persists between sessions automatically.

Triple Triad is a fan tribute to the classic card game from Final Fantasy VIII by Square Enix.
This project is not affiliated with or endorsed by Square Enix. All card artwork is AI-generated.